

The MOU on the next page was drafted when the conference was supposed to be transferred from the SBS to the AABC department at UA. The transfer did not occur, but it provides a useful template for how an MOU with IONS, and potentially UCSD, could look. This document did not have the detail of governance. It was more about financial transfer and it was just between Dante and Lori, who are two department directors.

Arnaud Delorme suggests keeping it simple. As Claudia noted, whatever we write will likely carry limited weight in court, and IONS is not going to pursue legal action anyway. **Adding legal language would likely trigger additional safeguards on the university side.** Lawyers and administrators would review it and might conclude that IONS is not an appropriate entity to take over the conference and that this could further affect UA's and UCSD's reputation. We are unlikely to proceed through the formal route with major universities, so it is better to keep a low profile. In any case, it would likely make little difference since IONS would not attempt to enforce such documents, which could also reflect poorly from an image standpoint.

For that reason, the suggestion is to keep the agreement simple and similar to what was done previously: a short, informal one page document stating that UA transfers the conference name and related assets, while IONS takes over financial management and UCSD oversees the scientific content.



THE UNIVERSITY OF ARIZONA

College of Social
& Behavioral Sciences

OFFICE OF THE DEAN

Douglass Building 200W
PO Box 210028
Tucson, AZ 85721-0028

Ofc: 520-621-1112

www.sbs.arizona.edu

To: Dante Lauretta, Director Arizona Astrobiology Center and Kim Patten, Acting Chief of Staff and AVP, Research Development Services, Research Innovation and Impact

From: Lori Poloni-Staudinger, Dean College of Social and Behavioral Sciences

Re: Conveyance of Science of Consciousness Conference

Date: 20 May 2025

This memo codifies the conveyance of the Science of Consciousness Conference (hereafter the conference) from The Center for Consciousness Studies in the College of Social and Behavioral Sciences (hereafter SBS) to the Arizona Astrobiology Center (hereafter AABC).

- 1.) AABC will assume responsibility for the conference beginning July 1, 2025.
- 2.) All personnel in SBS associated with the conference will transfer to AABC after all funds in account 2370431 have been expended. SBS will close this account once the fund exhaust date is reached
- 3.) Responsibility for honoring all contracts signed for the conference will transfer to AABC.
- 4.) SBS will transfer UA Foundation account **20-10-3352**, with an expected balance of **\$239,724**, on July 1, 2025 to AABC.
- 5.) SBS will make a \$10,000 sponsorship for the 2026 conference.
- 6.) The conference will waive the registration fees of 20 students during years the conference is held in Tucson for the first 5 years of this agreement.
- 7.) SBS will pay a fee of \$100 students for every student beyond 20 who registers (max of 50 additional students) for the first 5 years of this agreement.

- 8.) SBS and SBS faculty will continue to work in good faith to support the conference and maintain a collaborative relationship, providing sponsorship whenever funds are available.

Lori Poloni-Staudinger
Dean, College of Social and Behavioral
Sciences



Dante Lauretta
Director, Arizona Astrobiology
Center